



On Second Thought

By WILLIE KLEIN

A 'break' for Andy

With no reflection on Gene Mauch, who may be smarter than his quotes indicate, it's surprising that the boys in the Phillies front office decided to pass up Andy Cohen as Ed Sawyer's successor . . . Perhaps it was out of kindness since they figure Cohen needs his sleep just as much as Sawyer while Mauch is still young and frisky and better able to endure the nightmares the Phillies are bound to produce . . .

It's possible that Cohen might not have wanted the headache even if it had been offered but choosing him makes more sense than reaching out for whozis . . . Andy is wise in big league ways, has been bouncing around baseball since before Mauch was born, has experience and know how that will take Mauch years to acquire and, most important, commands respect . . .

This is no attempt to judge a man on one game but the way Andy handled the Phillies Thursday night against the Braves is clear evidence that the front office may have gooted by not asking him to take the job and shorten his life a little . . .

Mauch, suddenly hit by the bright lights, if managing the playboy Phillies can be called that, desperately needs someone to edit his immature statements . . . He may surprise a lot of people, his bosses, included, by becoming the next Boy Wonder manager (an achievement not likely with the Phillies) but his first move is to shut up . . .

Example: Mauch's expressed desire to be the best manager in the big leagues . . . Strictly Little League stuff over which the Phillies must be in stitches . . . Example: "The only kind of baseball I like is the winning kind (so find someone who likes the other kind?) and that's what I expect my team to do" . . . If Sawyer, Mayo Smith, Terry Moore and Steve O'Neill couldn't, who's Mauch? . . . Mauch may discover the Phillies aren't much better than the Indianapolis club he left . . .

Hurrah for Sawyer

Sudden thoughts: Will Ted Lepcio introduce himself to the new skipper as "the worst player Sawyer ever saw but he never saw you?" . . . Skippers like Chuck Dressen, Bill Rigney, Fred Hutchinson, even Walt Alston, who know their way around, can make a mish-mash out of Gene in the strategy department where games can be won and lost . . . The Phillies front office worsened its position by engaging Mauch instead of an experienced, hard-bitten whip-snapper . . . For Sawyer: First prize for smartest move of the season . . .

Isn't it about time that the Continental League, with all the money it's supposed to have, started buying or stealing players instead of crying to Congress twice a week that the majors don't want to hand them anything on a platter? . . . Bill Shea charges organized baseball is being monopolistic by not allowing the CL to grab players who are being held back in the minors . . . We thought it was the other way around, that some minor league players are being held back in the majors because there aren't enough to go around . . .

Suggestior to Ford Frick: Help the CL by giving them the Phillies and Senators for a starter and refill by picking from at least a half dozen eligible cities . . .

Ernie off and slugging

How long before they start calling Ernie Banks First National? . . . This could be the year that Banks closes in on Babe Ruth's 60 . . . With power following him in the batting order there'll be less inclination for pitchers to walk him . . . Ernie hits homers as frequently as Mauch makes silly remarks — 207 in the last five years . . . He has a running start now with two . . . Just to beat every one else in the country to comparisons, Babe didn't get No. 1 until his fourth game and No. 2 until the 11th . . . He had only four in 14 April games . . .

The Phillies may have lengthened Richie Ashburn's career by swapping him to the Cubs where he will not have to run down as many hits on ground balls that get through the middle . . . The Banks-Tony Taylor combination will stop more of them than the Phillies did . . . Jim Gleeson, left fielder for the 1937 Newark Wonder Team, is managing Amarillo, which is in the Texas League for the first time this year . . .

The Yanks must cut three players by Monday night and chances are Bobby Shantz, with a cranky shoulder, will be placed on the disabled list . . . That means 30 days inactivity while the Yanks mull whether he's washed up or not . . . Andy Carey is the next Yank ticketed for K.C. . . .

The White Sox are wondering if they bungled by trading Don Mincher to the Senators . . . The rookie first baseman has been on a slugging spree since while the White Sox have three ancients covering first for them — Ted Kluszewski, Roy Sievers and Earl Torgeson . . . This is what's called playing for the flag this year . . . Mincher represents two, three years hence, if ever . . .

Yanks have the only twin managers in baseball — the Charnofsky brothers . . . Hal pilots Greensboro and Stan skipper St. Petersburg . . . If Art Ditmar pitches more at night here's Casey Stengel's reason: Last year Art was 9-2 with an 1.91 ERA under the lights while in day games he was 4-7 with 3.75 . . . Insiders think Cletis Boyer will be the Yanks' regular shortstop by June 1 with Tony Kuzek going to the outfield . . . Boyer is a better glove man and is learning fast about batting from Bill Dickey . . .

Johnny Podres' kid brother, Walt, is a pitching candidate at St. Michael's College . . . The Giants' three lefties never served a single day apprenticeship in the minors or returned to the sticks after being in the majors . . . Bill O'Dell came off the Clemson campus to the Orioles in 1954, Johnny Antonelli left Jefferson High in Rochester to join the Braves in '48 and Mike McCormick joined the Giants in August, 1956, right out of his Alhambra, Calif., high school.